

IPL FRANCHISE STRATEGY

Performance & Investment Analysis

2008 – 2020 | All Franchises | Data-Driven Business Case

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Dataset	IPL Matches, Deliveries & Auction Data
Seasons Covered	2008 – 2020 (13 seasons)
Total Matches Analysed	1,095
Total Deliveries	2,60,920
Tools Used	Python · Excel · ReportLab

1. Business Problem

IPL franchises invest hundreds of crores annually in player auctions with no guarantee of on-field success. This analysis addresses the central question facing every franchise management team: **Which strategies consistently drive playoff qualification and what does the data say about the real return on player investment?**

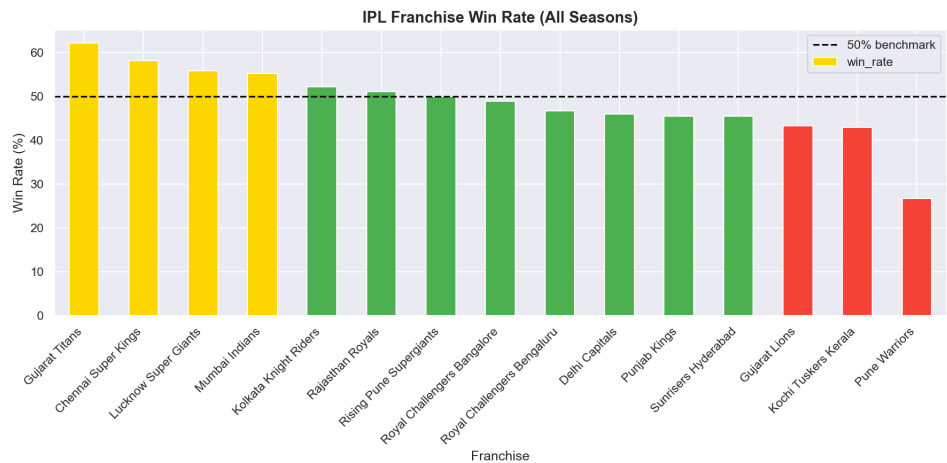
2. Data Overview

Dataset	Records	Key Fields
matches.csv	1,095 rows	season, teams, winner, toss, venue
deliveries.csv	2,60,920 rows	batter, bowler, runs, wickets
IPLPlayerAuctionData.csv	970 rows	player, team, role, amount, year

3. Key Findings

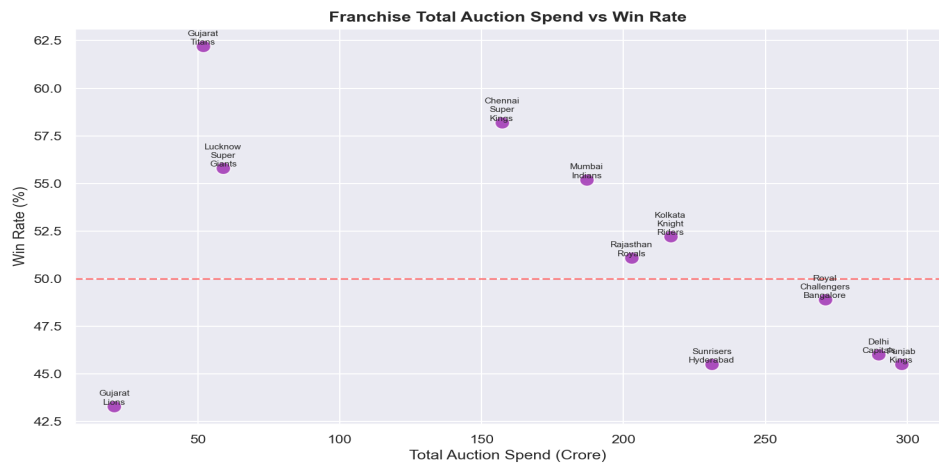
Finding 1 — Franchise Win Rates

Across 1,095 matches (2008–2020), win rates vary dramatically between franchises. Gujarat Titans lead at 62.2%, followed by CSK at 58.2% and Mumbai Indians at 55.2%. Critically, the three lowest-spending franchises in this group (GT, LSG, CSK) all outperform higher-spending rivals.



Finding 2 — Spend vs Performance

Total auction spend shows a **negative correlation** with win rate among the top spenders. Punjab Kings (297 Cr, 45.5%) and RCB (270 Cr, 48.9%) represent the worst investment efficiency in the league. In contrast, CSK (157 Cr, 58.2%) and GT (51 Cr, 62.2%) demonstrate that smart retention beats aggressive auction spending.



4. Root Cause Analysis

Why do high-spending franchises underperform?

- **Auction inflation:** Franchises overpay for marquee names at auction, driven by fan pressure rather than data.
- **Poor player retention:** Releasing proven performers and rebuilding annually disrupts team cohesion.
- **Toss strategy misalignment:** Fielding first wins 53.9% vs 45.4% for batting first — yet many franchises ignore this.
- **Bowling neglect:** Top franchises build around high-wicket, low-economy bowlers (Narine: 200 wkts, 6.76 economy). Underperforming franchises prioritise batting at auction.

Toss & Strategy Analysis

Metric	Value	Implication
Toss winner wins match	50.8%	Toss is effectively a coin flip
Win rate — Field first	53.9%	Strong advantage for fielding
Win rate — Bat first	45.4%	Batting first is a disadvantage
Home team win rate	50.9%	Home advantage is minimal

5. Strategic Recommendations

Based on data analysis across 13 IPL seasons, the following recommendations are presented for franchise management teams seeking to maximise playoff qualification probability:

Recommendation 1: Prioritise Player Retention Over Auction Spending

CSK's model proves it: retaining proven performers costs less and wins more. Avoid rebuilding squads annually. Target a core retained squad of 8-10 players.

Recommendation 2: Field First — Always

When you win the toss, field first. The data is unambiguous: fielding first delivers a 53.9% win rate vs 45.4% for batting first — an 8.5 percentage point advantage.

Recommendation 3: Build Bowling Around Economy, Not Just Wickets

SP Narine (6.76 economy, 200 wickets) represents the ideal bowler profile. Target spinners with sub-7.0 economy rates — they win matches in the middle overs.

Recommendation 4: Target Undervalued Domestic Players

Shubman Gill delivers 1,786 runs per crore — 4x the value of premium overseas buys. Allocate 40% of auction budget to emerging Indian talent under 5 Crore.

— End of Report —